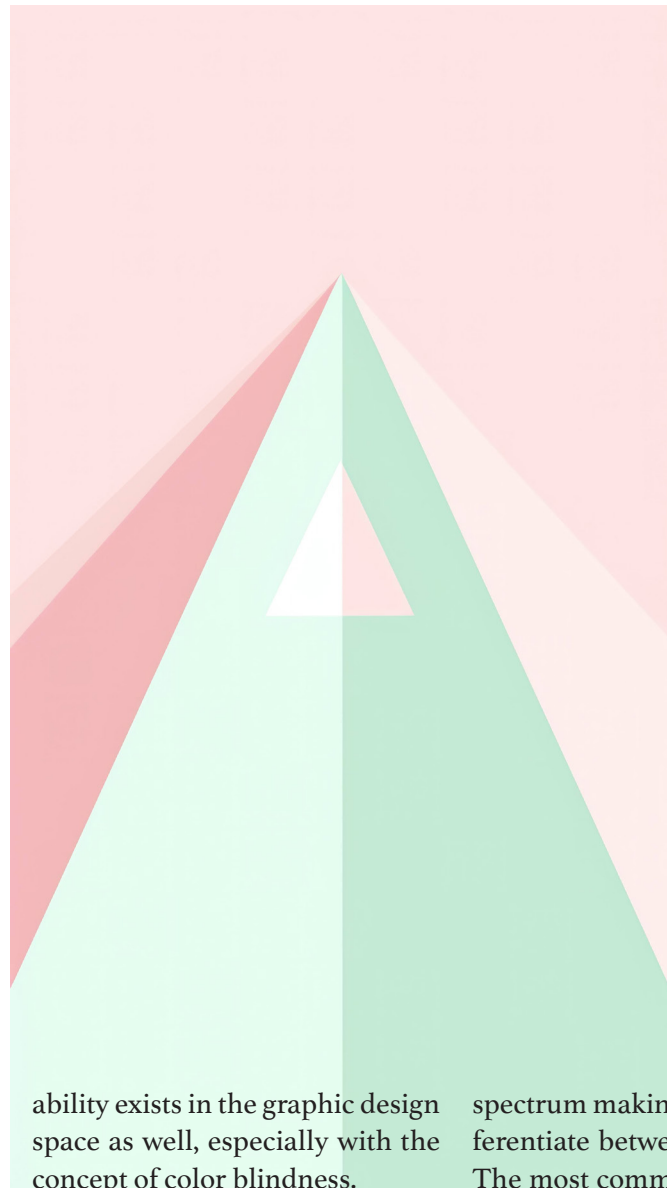


「 Dear Internet 」

I recently saw an interesting mode that allowed users to swap colorblindness mode in their website. Why is colorblind accessibility crucial for online content and design?

Dear user,

People are unique. No one person is the same as another. Our uniqueness leads to different ideas, philosophies, and gives meaning to our individuality. But we are also similar. There are many things that defines us and we tend to share these similar features helping us find connection. But because we can be different, it means there are certain aspects of our life that we will not share with others. Our ability to think, our physical appearance, or our perception of the world are some examples of things that can be similar and different depending on the group of people you examine. These differences could hinder our day-to-day life thus leading them to be labeled as a disability. As humans, we try to accommodate those who don't share the same privileges as us. Wheelchair-accessible ramps, glasses, and hearing aids are examples of physical properties we use to help those around us. However, dis-



ability exists in the graphic design space as well, especially with the concept of color blindness.

Color blindness is one of the most common, but also the easiest disability to accommodate for. Color blindness is caused by the absence or damage of certain conic cells that help us perceive colors (National Eye Institute). People with color blindness see colors differently from others, preventing them from seeing the full-color

spectrum making it difficult to differentiate between certain colors. The most common forms of color blindness are red-green deficiency and blue-yellow deficiency. Each of these color blindness has its subsections with red-green being divided up into deuteranomaly, protanomaly, protanopia, and deuteranopia. Blue-yellow deficiency includes tritanomaly and tritanopia (Enchroma). A rarer condition that cannot be accommodated is



complete color vision deficiency, preventing you from seeing any color at all.

In order to accommodate for color blindness, one must use colors that contrast well when viewed from the perspective of a color-blind person. You can use certain websites that preview how colors might be viewed for color-blind people. Or, more simply, you can use color palettes proven to work best for color-blind people. If

you're designing a website, you can have a settings menu that changes the color scheme best suited for a person. But for physical pages that can't be changed, it is best to limit your color palette to black and white shades, or high contrast colors like blue and orange. Overall, websites or web applications have the power to best accommodate color blindness with the ability to change themes on the spot. The United States Government



Protanopia



Tritanopia

has started taking precautions to work towards a color-blind friendly environment, so people should understand how it works.

But why must we accommodate for others? If you want an objective answer, you would hear something like this; Accessible graphic design ensures that visual content is perceivable, understandable, and usable by all individuals. But sometimes, the answer can be more simple. We want what's best for those around us. We want everyone to share the same experiences as us. We're all people living in our world, feeling the same pain, sharing the same happiness, and moving forward at the same time. We understand each other because we can relate to one another. We emphasize, sympathize, and try to understand each other because we're all doing our best. So, why is accessible graphic design important? Well, it's not. But we give it meaning because we want everyone to live the life that we want to live.

Faithfully,
Saurav.